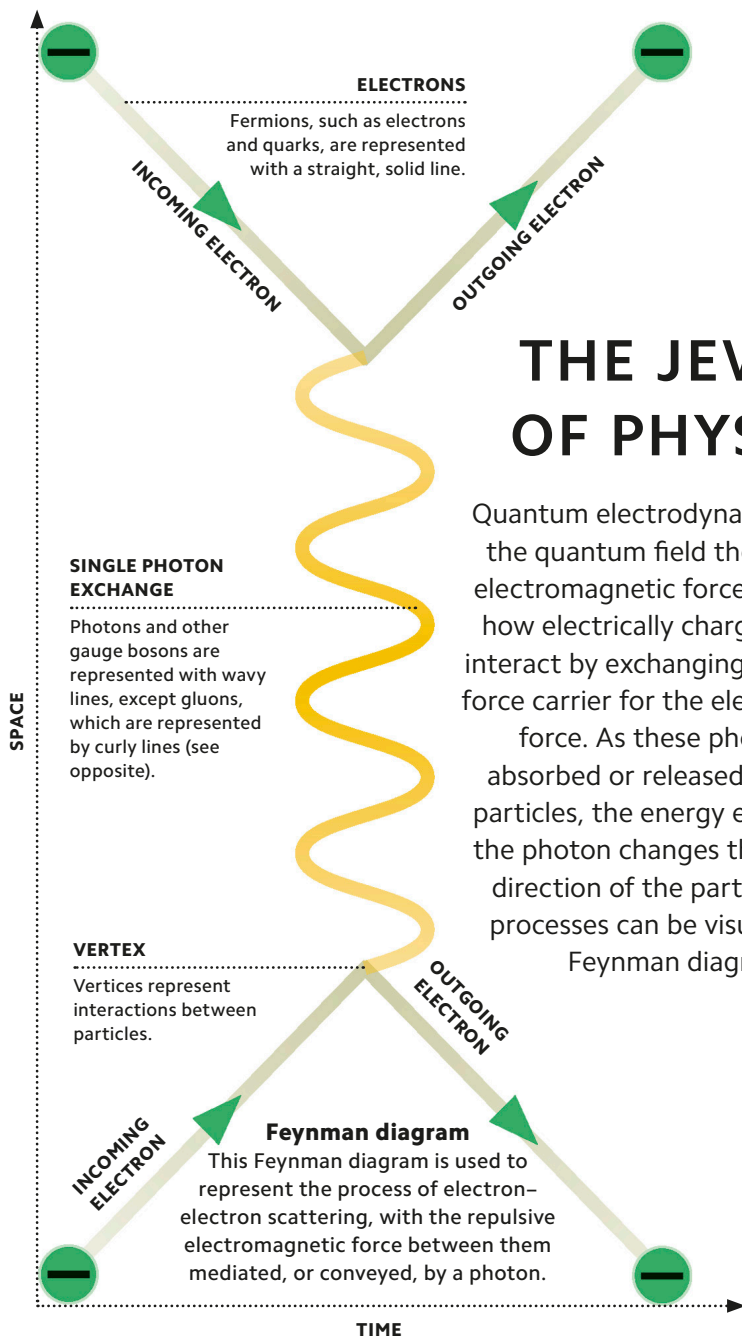




THE JEWEL OF PHYSICS

Quantum electrodynamics (QED) is the quantum field theory for the electromagnetic force. It describes how electrically charged particles interact by exchanging photons: the force carrier for the electromagnetic force. As these photons are absorbed or released by charged particles, the energy exchanged by the photon changes the speed and direction of the particles. These processes can be visualized with Feynman diagrams.